

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 36

By Russell

A RESOLUTION to honor the Tennessee Air National Guard 134th Air Refueling Wing at McGhee Tyson Air National Guard Base in Knoxville as it endeavors to be chosen by the U.S. Air Force to receive the next generation of air refueling aircraft, the KC-46 Pegasus.

WHEREAS, our nation was conceived by individuals who were willing to sacrifice their personal safety and concerns to ensure our individual and collective freedom, and the Volunteer State is especially proud to be the home of so many valiant men and women who continue to perform above and beyond the call of duty in the Tennessee Air National Guard; and

WHEREAS, truly displaying the Volunteer Spirit are the men and women of the 134th Air Refueling Wing of the Tennessee Air National Guard assigned to McGhee Tyson Air National Guard Base in Knoxville, where they have served our nation with distinction for many years; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. Air Force has developed a new tanker aircraft, designated the KC-46 Pegasus, a modern aircraft to replace the aging air refueling fleet of KC-135s, which first entered service in 1957; and

WHEREAS, it is our understanding that the Tennessee Air National Guard's 134th Air Refueling Wing is in competition with many other states to receive the new KC-46 Pegasus refueling aircraft and extend their mission into the next several decades; and

WHEREAS, McGhee Tyson Air National Guard Base in Knoxville is uniquely qualified to receive and employ the Air Force's next generation of air refueling aircraft due to its strategic location, robust infrastructure, and highly proficient Volunteer Airmen; and

WHEREAS, the Tennessee Air National Guard, with federal and state assistance, has modernized the maintenance and airport facility at McGhee Tyson Air National Guard Base, including a \$134 million, 10,000-foot runway and the completion of a \$32.4 million aircraft maintenance facility that is capable of housing a KC-46 Pegasus; and

WHEREAS, we are pleased to honor the Tennessee Air National Guard's 134th Air Refueling Wing at McGhee Tyson Air National Guard Base as it seeks to be chosen for the placement of the KC-46 Pegasus; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the Tennessee Air National Guard 134th Air Refueling Wing at McGhee Tyson Air National Guard Base in Knoxville and its efforts to be chosen by the U.S. Air Force to receive the next generation of air refueling aircraft, the KC-46 Pegasus.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.